



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Samuel Fuller School

School Website: <https://samuelfullerschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Samuel Fuller School (SFS) presents a clear classical Christian orientation across its public materials. The site/profile emphasizes Christ-centered classical education, formation of character, and a triadic structure of the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) through a Grammar & Logic School (K-8) and a Rhetoric School (9-12). It foregrounds formation of the whole person, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, and beauty, and it explicitly ties education to a Christian telos and the Word of God. Public statements about a Portrait of a Graduate, partnership with parents, and strong emphasis on Great Books and integrated formation align closely with the Six Essential Elements framework for classical education.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary notes - Public proclamations of a Christ-centered, classical Christian education for K-12, with explicit aim to form students who love and serve God with wisdom, grace, truth, and courage. - Explicit reference to classical pedagogy markers (Great Books immersion; Grammar & Logic vs. Rhetoric School structure). - Portrait of a Graduate emphasizes core intellectual and moral aims (listening, critical thinking, eloquent communication, service, faithfulness). - Strong parental partnership ethos and open-campus sensibilities; explicit parent-teacher collaboration language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school identifies itself as a Christ-centered Christian education rooted in the Word of God and seeks to form students under a Christian worldview. - The description explicitly frames education as a formation anchored in faith and virtue, with references to God, Jesus Christ, and Christian mission. - Public statements connect education to spiritual formation and moral order, consistent with a metaphysical grounding.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Christ-centered, Word of God, formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, true/eternal, moral order, sacred tradition (via Christian framing), great books (through Western civilization immersion cited in description). - Negative keywords: Not evident in public materials (no explicit relabeling of truth/goodness/beauty as relative; no clear secularizing signals observed). The site reads as theistic and objective-truth oriented rather than relativistic.

Why this rating - The materials foreground theological commitments and sacred vocabulary (God, Jesus Christ, Word of God) and align with transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) as real and knowable. This strongly matches Classical criteria for Transcendental Moral Realism and Grounded Theology. The explicit Christ-centered framing and liturgical/cohesive communal ethos further reinforce this.

Cited evidence: Christ-centered language and the Word of God; Portrait of a Graduate; Great Books language in the description.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Emphasis on formation of the whole person, not merely job preparation; stated aim to graduate students who love and serve God with wisdom, grace, truth, and courage. - Public articulation of education as formation and the telos of human flourishing within a Christian, classical frame. - Language tying the mission to truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable (a classical telos).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, telos, moral imagination, human flourishing, sacred tradition (via theological framing), great conversation (thematic alignment with classical mission). - Negative keywords: No clear emphasis on workforce-readiness or job-market metrics; rather, a formation-centric aim is foregrounded.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and human excellence as the end of education, with a clear telos rooted in truth, goodness, and beauty rather than solely in career outcomes. This aligns with classical aims of education as formation of character and intellect.

Cited evidence: Our Vision & Purpose language; classical education framing; Great Books framing.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials indicate a grammar/logic/rhetoric progression (Grammar & Logic School, Rhetoric School) for K–12, which is the classic Trivium structure. - Description and materials emphasize immersion in the Great Books of Western Civilization, aligning with the Great Books / Great Conversation curriculum hallmark. - Emphasis on classical formation and integrated study of disciplines (theology, literature, history) consistent with liberal arts approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; great conversation (via classical canon framing in the lexicon and description); history/humanities integration; formation through the liberal arts; classical mission. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no explicit modernist/STM-first framing; no project-based dominance suggested by the site). The content supports a traditional liberal-arts curriculum emphasis.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly described in terms of the Three Liberal Arts (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and Great Books/Narrative of Western civilization, with explicit triadic grade structure and integrated formation, which are core markers of Classical education.

Cited evidence: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure; Great Books immersion; public descriptions of classical education framing.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The explicit triad of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric implies a progressively rigorous pedagogy aligned with classical methods. - The site emphasizes formation, integrated study, and a Portrait of a Graduate that signals emphasis on disciplined, thoughtful communication and moral reasoning, hallmarks of classical pedagogy. - While explicit terms like Socratic seminars or scholé are not repeatedly spelled out on every page, the presence of a high school rhetoric program and the overall classical framing imply a pedagogy that includes Socratic-style inquiry and disciplined discourse typical of classical education. (These tendencies are reflected in the school's public alignment with classical methods and the lexicon's indicators.)

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: Socratic dialogue (implied by the classical/seminar-style pedagogy in the lexicon), mentoring/teacher-guided inquiry, rhetoric and discourse, memory work through a structured, classical sequence, contemplative formation. - Negative keywords: No explicit emphasis on algorithmic or project-based/constructed-response only approaches; the site does not foreground purely experiential learning as the dominant pedagogy.

Why this rating - The presence of grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, engagement with timeless classical methods, and a focus on formation through a structured, inquiry-oriented approach align with classical pedagogy.

Cited evidence: Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure; public articulation of classical methods and graduate outcomes; mention of formation and critical thinking language.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials feature named faculty (e.g., Our Team page) and emphasize character formation and virtue as part of the educational model. - The school describes a vision of teachers as part of the living curriculum and as mentors; the broader classical framework is reinforced through explicit references to formation, Great Books immersion, and a culture of virtue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: living curriculum; faculty as mentors; portrait of a teacher; virtuous exemplars; classical pedagogy; collaboration and collegiality (as inferred from the site's portrayal of team and mission). - Negative keywords: No explicit negative signals about faculty (e.g., non-classical staffing models) are present.

Why this rating - The site's emphasis on a cohesive, virtue-oriented faculty and the presence of named staff align with the classical expectation of model teachers and mentors who embody the school's ethos.

Cited evidence: Our Team page; Our Vision & Purpose / Portrait of a Graduate language.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly describes partnership with families and frames parents as co-teachers in a community of faith and learning. - There are dedicated pages for parent partnership, formation, and engagement; the site invites parent participation and family involvement as part of the classical formation process. - The public materials frame education as a shared mission with families and emphasize parent involvement in book studies, gatherings, and campus engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords found: partnership with families/co-teachers, parent formation, parent involvement, open campus, family-centered learning, classical parent training, intentional parenting, home-school alignment, living tradition in the family, family catechesis. - Negative keywords: None evident (no signals of parent negligence or customer-only engagement); rather, strong parental partnership is emphasized.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present parents as co-educators and collaborators in a shared classical mission, with explicit opportunities for parental involvement and learning, matching the classical standard for family engagement.

Cited evidence: Parent partnership language; Our Vision & Purpose; education as formation links to family engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. All six categories are classified as CLASSICAL based on current public materials. If desired, the school could further strengthen the Pedagogy and Curriculum sections by explicitly naming Socratic dialogue/seminars and scholé language in site copy to make these practices more transparent to prospective families.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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